

Black Lab Linux goes commercial

Black Lab Software has decided to leave the world of free and open source software (FOSS) and commercialise Black Lab Linux due to lack of funding. Robert Dohnert, CEO of Black Lab Software, made the official announcement on this.

Black Lab Linux 8 has been in the development mode. While its third beta build was released in September end, the company was supposed to launch the release candidate on October 11.

An official announcement from the CEO's desk first revealed the decision to move forward Black Lab Linux as a commercial-only software product. All the Black Lab based systems and hardware will now come under PC/OpenSystems LLC. The company has also decided to ship Black Lab Linux with the GNOME 3 desktop environment.

Black Lab Linux is set to continue with its development cycle.



However, users will have to pay US\$ 9.99 for a digital download and US\$ 19.99 for a boxed set of

the USB drive of the distribution. Version 8.0 of Black Lab Linux was released on November 1.

Users will be able to download the latest Linux distribution free for the first 45 days after the launch. Subsequently, Black Lab Enterprise Linux will remain a commercial-only product.

As a result of its commercialisation move, Black Lab Software is discontinuing the development of the cloud-based variant of the Linux version. The company also launched Black Lab Enterprise Linux 8.0 SP1 for enterprises on October 24.

by organisations like Red Hat, C-DAC, Mozilla and LibreOffice. More than 65 languages communities are working with FUEL,” Ranjan concluded.

In response to Google Home, Amazon enables Alexa Voice Service for developers

While Google recently attempted to make things difficult for Amazon Echo by launching its Home platform, the e-commerce giant has now planned to rival the Google project with its newest Alexa Voice Service (AVS) update. The Seattle-headquartered company has just enabled AVS for non-Alexa devices to encourage developers to test and enhance its platform.

Amazon has partnered with Sensory and KITT.AI, which enables the company to let developers test Alexa wakeup words on devices other than its Echo range of smart speakers. Software programmers can use this as an affordable solution on boards such as a Raspberry Pi to kick-start their developments for the Alexa assistant.

In addition to the original Alexa wakeup words, the integration of hotword detection engines from Sensory and KITT.AI lets developers build their own wakeup word-enabled Amazon Alexa model. This would help Amazon attract more developers and make iconic hotwords like ‘Hey Siri’ and ‘OK Google’ a thing of the past.

Notably, California-based Sensory already has a record of offering its machine learning techniques to Android OEMs like Motorola and Samsung to enable ‘OK Google’ and ‘Hey Galaxy’ hotwords on smartphones. KITT.AI, which focuses on natural language understanding (NLU) technologies, also enabled more than 2,000 developers to integrate over 1,000 unique hotwords using its Snowboy toolkit.

All this would give Amazon the power to enable some advanced voice recognition experiences for developers to compete against Google Home, which presently offers an Echo-like experience on a handful of devices.

Developers have already been provided with the updated AVS API to deliver the next-generation experience. Moreover, a GitHub repository is live with the AVS sample app that you can install on your Raspberry Pi using a Java client and Node.js server.

OpenStack Newton gets official with unified cloud experience



The OpenStack Foundation has launched OpenStack Newton as an upgraded open source cloud-building solution. This new release is targeted at offering a unified cloud experience with virtualisation, bare metal and container support.

OpenStack Newton enhances the existing bare metal provisioning service, and includes the Magnum container orchestration cluster manager and the Kuryr container networking project. These inputs enable the software to handle organisations with heterogeneous environments.

“The new features and enhancements in Newton underscore the power of OpenStack. It handles more workloads in more ways across more industries, worldwide,” said Jonathan Bryce, executive director of the OpenStack Foundation, in a statement.

OpenStack Newton includes enhancements such as improved scale-up/scale-down capabilities in Nova, Horizon and Swift. The platform can scale up or down across platforms and geographies.